



The Propagator

The Monthly Newsletter of the South Orange Amateur Radio Association

July 2026

South Orange Amateur Radio Association | Editor: Ray Frericks, K6NOV

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This Month — July 2026

Date	Time	Event	Location
Saturday, July 18	9:00 AM	SOARA Elmer Saturday	Gillieran Park
Monday, July 20	6:00 PM	Ham Radio License Exams	Murray Center
Monday, July 20	6:30 PM	Membership Meeting	Murray Center
Monday, July 27	7:00 PM	Board Meeting	Murray Center

Next Month — August 2026

Date	Time	Event	Location
Saturday, August 15	9:00 AM	SOARA Elmer Saturday	Gillieran Park
Monday, August 17	6:00 PM	Ham Radio License Exams	Murray Center
Monday, August 17	6:30 PM	Membership Meeting	Murray Center
Saturday, August 22	11:00 AM	SOARA Summer Picnic	Laguna Niguel Regional Park
Monday, August 24	7:00 PM	Board Meeting	Murray Center

Dates, locations, and times are subject to change. Check the [SOARA website](#) before attending.

President's Message

SOARA held our Field Day operations as planned on June 26-28. On Friday, starting around 3 p.m., we unpacked, put up tents, erected antennas, ran coax and tested radios, filters and a triplexer. 15 members helped with setup. We finished up Saturday morning and started the propane powered generator just before 11 a.m. so that we could run the radios on

"alternate power," which allowed us to use our usual 3A designation. This allows three active HF radios, a separate VHF/UHF radio and a GOTA (Get On The Air) station. Operations started at about 11:10 a.m. and continued to 11:00 a.m. Sunday morning. We had 34 SOARA members attend on Saturday and 19 on Sunday. Tear down started around 11 a.m. and we were all done before 2 p.m.



SOARA members gather at the club's 2026 Field Day site.

We had a tent and display from MVRACES and were also joined by the Mesa Crest Repeater Club. They brought several tents, a grill with great grilled hot dogs (with bacon!) which were very tasty and much appreciated. They even cooked a few extra for Saturday night dinner for SOARA. The energy and excitement that Mesa Crest brought to SOARA's Field Day event was great. They expressed their thanks for our invitation and they hope to join us next year.

There were 32 visitors signed in on Saturday. Our GOTA station was busy doing demos and Ed Barnes, WA6ED, ran the education table with a number of exhibits for demos. I found them interesting and there were a lot of discussions about what was being shown.

We put up a new 80M/40M setup on the ball field, using a 35 foot heavy duty mast holding up nearly flat inverted "V" antennas guyed to opposite fences on the baseball field. We used two lengths of coax to feed the antennas through some common mode chokes at the antenna feed point. This new antenna setup worked pretty well by all reports. It took less

than an hour to erect and take down and did not depend on using the baseball field lighting poles as elevated guy points, which has been a problem in recent years.



RJ and Dale at the Field Day antenna site.

I want to thank everyone who attended Field Day, especially those who helped setup and tear down the operation. We had quite a number of operators of the various stations helping SOARA get points for our submission to ARRL, but also, hopefully enjoying using much better antenna setups than they might have at home.

I would also like to take this opportunity to encourage all SOARA members that did not attend to consider attending in future years. Field Day is an interesting and rewarding event that is worth attending.

Finally, as part of the operation planning, I would like to hear suggestions for improvements or things you noticed while attending that we should change for next year. Send any ideas to w6edt@soara.org.

Our Annual Picnic is coming up on August 22 at the Laguna Niguel Regional Park from 11 a.m. until about 3 p.m. I hope to see you there!

73,

Dale Tyler, W6EDT SOARA President

SOARA Field Day 2026 — By the Numbers

Compiled from the K6SOA Field Day 2026 contact log. All times Pacific Daylight Time (PDT, UTC-7).

Another Field Day is in the books for the South Orange Amateur Radio Association, and K6SOA delivered a solid 24-hour performance across 10 bands and three operating modes. From the first contact at 11:00 AM PDT Saturday to the final QSO just after 10:00 AM Sunday, operators kept the chairs warm, the rigs hot, and the log growing.

When the dust settled, K6SOA had logged **660 QSOs** with **597 unique stations** spanning **75 ARRL sections** plus DX — reaching all corners of the country and landing contacts on four continents.

QSO Totals by Band and Mode

Band	Phone	CW	Digital	Total
160m	0	0	1	1
80m	7	7	21	35
40m	131	11	16	158
20m	227	70	28	325
15m	84	16	3	103
10m	11	0	0	11
6m	7	0	0	7
2m	12	0	0	12
1.25m	5	0	0	5
70cm	3	0	0	3
Total	487	104	69	660

20 meters was the workhorse of the event, accounting for nearly half of all contacts (325 QSOs, 49%). The 40 meter band was a close second with 158 QSOs, particularly productive after dark. 15 meters surprised with a strong showing of 103 contacts, a welcome sign of improving solar conditions. The VHF/UHF contingent made their mark too, with contacts on 2m, 1.25m, and 70cm adding some local flavor to the log.

Score Summary

Category	Value
Phone QSOs (487×1 pt)	487
CW QSOs (104×2 pts)	208
Digital QSOs (69×2 pts)	138
QSO Points	833

Note: Final official score will include applicable bonus points (e.g., emergency power, public information, satellite, etc.).

Sections Worked — 75 Domestic + DX

K6SOA worked **75 of the 84 ARRL/RAC sections**, a strong geographic footprint. Sections logged:

AB · AL · AR · AZ · BC · CO · CT · EB · EMA · ENY · EPA · EWA · GA · GH · IA · ID · IL · IN · KS · KY · LA · LAX · MDC · ME · MI · MN · MO · MS · MT · NB · NC · ND · NE · NFL · NH · NLI · NM · NNJ · NNY · NTX · NV · OH · OK · ONS · OR · ORG · PAC · PR · QC · RI · SB · SC · SCV · SDG · SF · SFL · SJV · SK · SNJ · STX · SV · TN · UT · VA · VI · VT · WCF · WI · WMA · WNY · WPA · WTX · WV · WWA · WY

DX Highlights

Five international contacts made it into the log — a nice bonus for the club:

Callsign	Country
J48UJE	Greece
LT3E	Argentina
JA8HYN	Japan
JK1DDG	Japan
YB2FAJ	Indonesia

Reaching Greece and Indonesia on Field Day power and antennas is no small feat!

Operating Rate — Hour by Hour (PDT)

The first few hours after the 11:00 AM gun were slow as operators settled in. The rate exploded in the afternoon and hit its peak of **77 QSOs in a single hour at 7:00 PM Saturday** — a blistering pace that speaks to well-organized operating and good band conditions.

Time (PDT)	QSOs	Time (PDT)	QSOs
Sat 11:00 AM	4	Sun 12:00 AM	27
Sat 12:00 PM	17	Sun 1:00 AM	20
Sat 1:00 PM	26	Sun 2:00 AM	10
Sat 2:00 PM	58	Sun 3:00 AM	15
Sat 3:00 PM	61	Sun 4:00 AM	15
Sat 4:00 PM	13	Sun 5:00 AM	15
Sat 5:00 PM	10	Sun 6:00 AM	34
Sat 6:00 PM	32	Sun 7:00 AM	28
Sat 7:00 PM	77 (peak)	Sun 8:00 AM	34
Sat 8:00 PM	43	Sun 9:00 AM	60
Sat 9:00 PM	11	Sun 10:00 AM	18
Sat 10:00 PM	12		

Time (PDT)	QSOs	Time (PDT)	QSOs
Sat 11:00 PM	20	Total	660

The overnight hours (midnight–5 AM) were quiet but steady, with the team keeping contacts in the log through the early morning. A strong second wind hit at 9:00 AM Sunday with another 60-QSO hour to close out the event.

Operator Breakdown

Seventeen operators took turns at the mic and key over the 24-hour period. A huge thank-you to everyone who sat down, put on headphones, and pushed the rate!

Operator	Phone	CW	Digital	Total
WE4BY	160	0	0	160
K6CHR	151	0	0	151
KN6HEC	78	0	0	78
WB6RDO	0	68	0	68
K6UVR	4	0	46	50
N6SNX	23	0	0	23
WA6LDI	0	23	0	23
KK6UME	23	0	0	23
K6HIV	18	0	0	18
KN6KOR	7	0	9	16
N6RPR	0	0	14	14
K6MSM	12	0	0	12
KO6AOL	0	10	0	10
K0PGE	9	0	0	9
KN6HI	0	2	0	2
AE6H	2	0	0	2
W6EDT	0	1	0	1

Special recognition to **WE4BY** and **K6CHR** for logging 160 and 151 QSOs respectively — the backbone of the phone effort. On CW, **WB6RDO** led the charge with 68 contacts, supported by **WA6LDI** (23). The digital station was anchored by **K6UVR** (46 digital QSOs) and **N6RPR** (14).

Thank You!

A successful Field Day takes far more than the operators in the log. Thank you to everyone who helped set up antennas, haul equipment, provide food and fellowship, and keep the site running around the clock. Field Day is one of the best demonstrations of what amateur radio is all about — community, preparedness, and the sheer fun of making contacts.

See you next year — and in the meantime, let's keep the radios on!

Membership Meeting: Antenna Analysis Software

Our July meeting is **Monday, July 20, 2026** at the **Norman P. Murray Center** in Mission Viejo. License exams start at 6:00 PM and the program begins at 6:30 PM.

This month's program features live demonstrations of antenna analysis (modeling) software. We're looking for two or three members to show their favorite tools — for example, **EZNEC Pro2+ v7.0** (free from eznec.com) or **AutoEZ** (\$79 from AC6LA Software, requires Microsoft Excel). Slides are welcome, but let's keep it hands-on. If you'd like to present — or learn a package and report back — contact Greg Unruh, WE4BY, at we4by@soara.org. We hope to see you there!

SOARA Saturday Report

SOARA's Elmer Saturday in June drew 11 attendees: Ed, WA6ED; Greg, N6PM; Tom, W6TRG; Ray, K6NOV; Greg, WE4BY; Ray, AE6H; Claude, W6CAG; Dale, W6EDT; Jim, KI6LOM; Patti, AD6OH; and Mike, KO6AOL.

We had donuts! We started with a \$0 balance from last month; the donuts cost \$20 and we took in \$30, so we have \$10 for next month. Thank you, Greg, N6PM, for bringing them — they looked really good this month, with only a few holes and one donut left over. Volunteers are always welcome at SOARA Saturday.



The donuts looked really good this month.

Greg, WE4BY, demoed a kit he built that controls his HF rig. Later, Greg and Dale tested HF filters that Patti, AD6OH, brought; these filters are from the late Howard Brown (SK). We had the big room, which was nice for spreading out a bit, and we also had an interesting conversation about AI.



Greg, WE4BY, demonstrates a kit he built to control his HF rig.

Ed, WA6ED, demoed a red Bird wattmeter showing average and peak power. The RAK Wireless 1-watt unit showed about 0.7 watt on peak; later at home, Ed observed 1 watt / 30 dBm on the spectrum analyzer with a 60 dB attenuator.



Ed, WA6ED, shows average and peak power on a Bird wattmeter.

Ahead of Field Day, Ed prepared four demonstrations for the education table: a Bioenno station to demo 12 V power (how we power our radios); an SWR station to demo antenna measurement with a NanoVNA (understanding antennas and tuners); an RF power station to demo RF power out with a Bird wattmeter; and a harmonic station to demo the TinySA in harmonics mode (understanding FCC compliance).



We had the big room this month — nice to spread out a bit.

Renewing Your DMR Number Through RadioID.net

Submitted by Ray Hutchinson, AE6H

This is from my "Right Coast" club, the Pine State Amateur Radio Club (PSARC).

The following is a great response from Dave, N1DAE to another PSARC member who asked, "What the heck is RadioID and why didn't the FCC handle this when I renewed my license? Is this a scam? Why is this non-transparent?" As you may know, you need to update your DMR (Digital Mobile Radio) account whenever you renew your ham license. Dave, N1DAE, wrote the following detailed explanation, and if you are a DMR user, and get or recently got a notice to renew your DMR registration number from RadioID, this may interest you. It's been slightly edited to be less PSARC-specific, and more generic. Our thanks to Dave, N1DAE.

To: (Name changed),

If you got your DMR ID a good number of years ago, and have just used your radio since then, I can see how things may not make sense. There have been announcements through the years about changes made to the DMR ID system and database. It certainly hasn't been non-transparent. However, we all get such an avalanche of communications it's easy to miss some key info along the way... even if you still use the same e-mail you did ten years ago.

First, a little bit of history as I remember it, explaining how we got where we are...

"Back in the day," when DMR IDs were first issued, the initial DMR ID system was developed and managed by DMR-MARC. As the DMR system/mode expanded worldwide and some other organizations started issuing IDs, like Ham-Digital, the decision was made to move the ID management to a single larger and more universal organization. To my knowledge, this is where RadioID.net came from.

All the existing information (callsigns/IDs) from different ID registration systems was consolidated into RadioID.net. Each ham who has an ID, at some point, needed to log in to RadioID.net to finish setting up their free account. From the sounds of it you didn't know this and never did so. It isn't a huge deal and should be fairly easy to fix. I'll get to that in a second.

ID numbers for DMR, and some other digital modes like NXDN, are an optional (and free) thing. Every ham doesn't automatically get assigned one. It has always been up to any ham who wants one to upload a copy of their license to the current ID manager for verification and then assignment of an ID number. These groups have never been plugged into the FCC.

You must have uploaded your license a good number of years ago because you have a DMR ID. Maybe you used DMR-MARC or Ham-Digital but it doesn't matter. Your information was ultimately pulled into RadioID.net when the consolidation took place. They have temporarily invalidated your ID in the database simply because the copy of your license they have on file has expired. Since you've renewed your license with the FCC, you just need to upload a new official copy (not a scan) to RadioID.net. Your radio won't just stop working until then, but you should avoid using DMR until your info is updated in their database.

Step 1: From the sounds of it you need to (re)gain access to, or finish setting up, your RadioID.net account. If there's a chance you still use the e-mail that would have been connected to your original DMR ID submission, you might be able to get in using the RadioID.net "Forgot Password" link.

- If you've never logged in to RadioID, or can't for any number of reasons, there is an entry on their FAQ page which explains how to get back up and running. The link for a Support Ticket is located on the left of the home page under Help/Support. You don't need to be logged in to send a ticket. Explain in your ticket that you don't ever remember logging in to RadioID (or can't) and you want to get your account info updated so you can upload your new license. The ticket system isn't "live," and to my knowledge it's staffed by volunteers, but they're fairly responsive and should still be able to get you up and running pretty quick.

Step 2: Once you're able to log in to RadioID.net, you'll need to upload an official PDF copy (not a scan) of your license.

- You will need to download it from the FCC. RadioID.net has no way to retrieve it directly or automatically. The reason they would have sent you a reminder/warning is because the license copy they have on file, that you would have uploaded to one of the earlier systems, was expiring. They don't use or have access to any FCC record or "data stream."
- It's been a while since I did this but I think you upload your license by updating your "Identity." My license expires in December so helping you get squared away will be a good refresher!
- Once your license is uploaded they will verify it in short order and your ID will be "valid" for another 10 years.

It's likely been as much as a decade since you had to do anything with your DMR ID record in the database and the database manager has changed from what you likely used before. Getting your ID record updated isn't as cumbersome as renewing your license with the FCC but, just like that journey, you only need to do an update with the ID database manager, currently RadioID.net, every ten years.

Hope this helps. If you get stuck along the way let me know. I'm happy to lend a hand.

73, Dave, N1DAE / WRQL942

Treasurer's Report

Reporting period: October 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026 (nine months) **Prepared by:** Ron Mosher, K0PGE, SOARA Treasurer

Through the first nine months of the fiscal year, total cash income was \$10,238.14, down \$3,092.86 from the same period a year earlier, driven mainly by lower memberships and interest/other income. Total cash expenses were \$11,163.78, up \$2,625.78 year over year. Cash net income for the period was \$(925.64), compared with \$4,793.00 a year earlier. Ending cash on June 30, 2026 stood at \$27,253.39.

Nine Months	June 2026	June 2025	Increase/(Decrease)
Cash Income:			
Memberships	\$8,015.00	\$9,733.00	\$(1,718.00)
Other & Interest	\$2,223.14	\$3,598.00	\$(1,374.86)
Total Cash Income	\$10,238.14	\$13,331.00	\$(3,092.86)
Cash Expenses:			
Repeaters incl. site rental, utilities & insurance	\$5,527.06	\$5,169.00	\$358.06
Member Activities	\$2,855.42	\$2,174.00	\$681.42
Other expenses	\$2,781.30	\$1,195.00	\$1,586.30
Total Cash Expenses	\$11,163.78	\$8,538.00	\$2,625.78
Cash Net Income	\$(925.64)	\$4,793.00	\$(5,718.64)
Beginning Cash — October 1	\$28,179.03	\$25,745.00	\$2,434.03
Ending Cash — June 30	\$27,253.39	\$30,538.00	\$(3,284.61)

If any member has questions about the financials, please contact the Treasurer or any Board member.

SOARA Information

Meetings: SOARA meets at the Norman P. Murray Center, 24932 Veterans Way, Mission Viejo, CA on the third Monday of every month at 7:00 PM. For January and February, the third Monday is a holiday and the meeting is held on the fourth Monday.

License Exams: Amateur license exams are given prior to SOARA meetings, except June. Exams are at 6:00 PM. Prior registration is not required and walk-in applicants are welcome. For June, exams are held at Field Day. For further information, email Steve Kuver, K6UVR, at k6uvr@soara.org.

SOARA Library: SOARA has many amateur radio related books such as handbooks, books about electrical theory, and more available to lend to club members. Contact library@soara.org for more information.

Web Site: SOARA maintains a web site with current club information at soara.org.

Repeaters

The Laguna Beach, San Clemente, and Trabuco repeaters are open. The Santiago Peak repeaters are closed. For details or questions on the repeaters, contact the repeater director at repeater@soara.org.

Band	Frequency	Shift	Tone / Notes	Location
2m	147.645	-	(110.9)	Laguna Beach
2m	146.025	+	(110.9)	San Clemente
2m	145.240	-	(110.9)	Trabuco
D-STAR 2m	146.115	+	(K6SOA C)	Laguna Beach
220	224.100	-	(110.9)	Laguna Beach
220	224.640	-	(pvt)	Santiago Peak (C)
440	445.660	-	(110.9)	Laguna Beach
D-STAR 440	445.705	-	(K6SOA B)	Laguna Beach
440	447.180	-	(pvt)	Santiago Peak (C)
D-STAR 1.2G	1282.600	-	(K6SOA A)	Laguna Beach

Nets

- 40 meter HF (7.200 MHz +/-): Sundays at 8:00 AM
- 10 meter HF (Technicians welcome) (28.415 +/-): Sundays at 9:00 AM
- General Membership Net — UHF/VHF (447.180, 147.645 & 224.640): Tuesdays at 8:00 PM

- D-STAR (146.115 C module): Wednesdays at 8:00 PM
- Tech Net — 147.645, 224.640, 447.180: Saturdays at 9:00 AM
- California Rescue Communications (Gordo Net) HF (7.250 MHz +/- for QRM): Weekdays at 8:30 AM
- MVRACES — 447.180: Tuesdays at 7:00 PM
- Tri-Cities RACES — 146.025: Wednesdays at 8:00 PM
- LNACS — 147.645: Thursdays at 7:00 PM
- OC Parks Fire Watch — 447.180: Thursdays at 8:00 PM

SOARA Officers

- **President:** Dale Tyler, W6EDT — w6edt@soara.org — 949-360-1717
- **Vice President:** Greg Unruh, WE4BY — we4by@soara.org
- **Secretary:** Charles Schultz, NY6I — ny6i@soara.org
- **Treasurer:** Ron Mosher, K0PGE — k0pge@soara.org — 949-363-0047

SOARA Directors

- **Repeater:** Open
- **Publications:** Ray Frericks, K6NOV — k6nov@soara.org
- **Membership:** Open
- **Education:** Steve Kuver, K6UVR — k6uvr@soara.org — 949-874-1972
- **Technical:** Tom Hobbs, AE6SH — ae6sh@soara.org — 949-887-6527
- **Communications:** Ray Hutchinson, AE6H — ae6h@soara.org

SOARA Appointments

- **Past President:** Ray Hutchinson, AE6H — ae6h@soara.org
- **Activities Coordinator:** Open
- **SOARA Saturdays:** Ed Barnes, WA6ED — wa6ed@soara.org — 949-468-7706
- **Raffle:** Open
- **Testing:** Steve Kuver, K6UVR — k6uvr@soara.org
- **Website:** Open

Contacting SOARA

Website: soara.org | Membership: membership@soara.org | Postal: P.O. Box 2545, Mission Viejo, CA 92690 | Facebook: K6SOA | Twitter/X: @K6SOA

Dates, locations, times, and frequencies are subject to change. Check the SOARA website before attending an event.

Questions about SOARA? membership@soara.org | P.O. Box 2545, Mission Viejo, CA 92690 | soara.org | Facebook/X: K6SOA